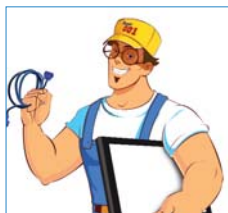
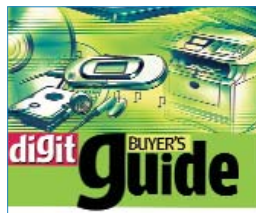




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**100** The Display Dilemma



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# Digital Tools

Technology For Personal And SoHo Productivity

Enhance

## Working Comfortably

**Do you suffer from backaches? Eyestrain? Fingers hurting? No, this isn't an ad for a balm or spray! Those are the cures—we're here to tell you about prevention**

**Robert Sovereign-Smith**

**E**rgonomics is the science that studies the relationship of humans to their working environment. It seeks to improve working conditions and increase efficiency.

The human body is fragile, more so as one grows older. Those of you above the age of 30 will have realised this. Those below that age will come to realise it soon—you just don't seem to be as flexible as you were when younger; and niggling aches and pains creep in.

The problem is compounded when you introduce the work factor. Today, many Indians spend more time working than doing anything else, and this is where ergonomics comes in—at least, it should.

### Work Forces

It's still a popular misconception among many that only those who do manual work need to consider ergonomics. This just isn't true—a worker who daily loads heavy packages on or off a truck is exposed to the same level of risk to his or her back as is a call centre employee. And chances are, the manual worker and the call centre employee will suffer from back pain as the years go by!

The same applies to a teacher who spends hours a day grading papers, as well as the students who spend hours writing them. When it comes to ergonomics, there's no difference between a journalist writing articles for hours on end on a computer, and a gamer mesmerised by the latest title for hours or days!

